Stefano Scibilia

PhD Candidate in Political Science, Erasmus University Rotterdam

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RESEARCH PROFILE

I am a political scientist working on European Union economic governance and the domestic politics of socio-economic reform in EU Member States.

Research interests: EU governance, comparative political economy, social policy, case study research

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2023–present **PhD Candidate in Political Science**, Policy, Politics, and Society, Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences, Erasmus University Rotterdam.

- Doctoral research is focused on understanding how domestic politics within Member States affect the Europeanization of socio-economic policy. Conducted in-depth process tracing analyses of labour market and pension reforms in Italy and Spain, with a particular focus on the "domestic effect" of the European Semester, the Recovery and Resilience Facility, and the Stability and Growth Pact in the 2011–2025 period.
- Part of the research project *Towards a resilient European Union? Post-pandemic economic governance amidst politicisation* (PEGAP), funded by the Dutch Research Council (NWO).
- Supervisors: prof. dr. Markus Haverland (main supervisor and PEGAP principal investigator), dr. Asya Zhelyazkova, dr. Pieter Tuytens.

EDUCATION

2021–2022 **University of Amsterdam** (NL). MSc in Political Science (Political Economy track).

2018–2020 **Durham University** (UK). MSc in Economics.
Including Erasmus+ research stay for the MSc dissertation at Stockholm University (June–September 2019).

2014–2018 **Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore** (IT). BSc in Economics, Organizations and Finance (Finance and Global Markets track).

PUBLICATIONS

Forthcoming and under review

Forthcoming **Scibilia, S.**, and Haverland, M. *The RRF and social policy*. In Copeland, P., and Schreurs, S. (eds.), Research Handbook on the EU and Social Policy. Edward Elgar.

2026 **Scibilia, S.**, and Haverland, M. *From external to internal constraints? Nominal compliance and the Europeanization of socio-economic reforms under the Recovery and Resilience Facility in Spain*. Revise and resubmit, Journal of Common Market Studies.

Scibilia, S., Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Domestic coalitions and (non)compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference for Italian pension and labour market reforms?* Under review.

Conference papers

2026 **Scibilia, S.** *From the Recovery and Resilience Plans to the Medium-term Fiscal-structural Plans: the case of pension policy*. 13th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Catania, 1–3 July.

Scibilia, S., and Haverland, M. *From external to internal constraints? Social pacts and socio-economic reforms under the Recovery and Resilience Facility in Spain*. 13th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Catania, 1–3 July.

Scibilia, S., and Haverland, M. *Does RRF-induced centralization lead to structural reforms?* 22nd Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Ghent, 5–6 February.

Scibilia, S. *Domestic coalitions and (non)compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference in Italy?* X Convegno Società Italiana di Sociologia Economica (SISEC), Florence, 28–31 January.

2025 **Scibilia, S.**, Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Domestic coalitions and compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference in Italy?* 19th Biennial Conference of the European Union Studies Association, Philadelphia, 8–10 May.

Scibilia, S., Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Does the Recovery and Resilience Facility tilt the balance?* 21st Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Ghent, 6–7 February.

2024 **Scibilia, S.**, Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Tilting the balance: the Recovery and Resilience Facility and labor market reforms inside the Italian political laboratory*. 12th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Lisbon, 19–21 June.

2023 **Scibilia, S.** *Continuity and change in EU governance: does the RRF alter the patterns of CSR compliance in the EU South?* 20th Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Delft, 2–3 November.

TEACHING

2025 **Thesis supervision seminar** *Politics and Policy of the European Union*, BSc Management of International Social Challenges (MISOC), Erasmus University Rotterdam. 8 students; one thesis won the 2025 MISOC Impact Thesis Award.

2024 **Thesis supervision seminar** *European Union Governance in the Age of the Polycrisis*, BSc MISOC, Erasmus University Rotterdam. 8 students.

2023 **Thesis supervision seminar** *Reforming the South of the EU: a Path Hard to Follow*, BSc MISOC, Erasmus University Rotterdam. 5 students.

METHODS TRAINING

Jul 2025 **MethodsNET Summer School**, Central European University, Vienna: Comparative Research Designs; Comparative Historical Analysis.

Feb 2025 **ECPR Methods School** (online), KU Leuven: Process Tracing Methods; Interviews as Method of Data Collection in Times of Polarisation.

2023–2025 **Netherlands Institute of Governance** PhD courses: Formulating and Answering Research Questions; Responsibility and Integrity in Research / The Politics of Research; Classic Themes and Contemporary Challenges for Public Governance; Current Themes in EU Governance; Preparing Your Future Academic Career.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND SOCIETAL OUTREACH

Nov 2026 **Co-organiser**, *Lessons from and beyond the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)*, a one-day event for EU and national policymakers on socio-economic reforms in the national recovery and fiscal-structural plans, with the European Social Observatory (OSE).

2025–2026 **Peer reviewer** for *Journal of European Public Policy*, *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, and *International Environmental Agreements: Politics, Law and Economics*.

Member of the European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR), the Netherlands Institute of Governance (NIG), and the Società Italiana di Sociologia Economica (SISEC).

LANGUAGES

Italian (native) · English (fluent) · Spanish (basic) · French (basic)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2020–2021 **Risk Management Intern**, Bosch Rexroth Italia, Cernusco sul Naviglio (Milan), December 2020 – August 2021: business continuity management and export-control compliance.